

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about peer pressure:

Peer pressure amongst teens

Peer pressure is one thing that all teenagers have in common, whether it is pressure to conform to a group norm or pressure to act a certain way because *everyone else is doing it*.

Teenagers begin to spend a lot more time with their friends, and less time with their family. The need for acceptance, approval, and belonging amongst friends is vital during the teen years. This makes them more vulnerable to the influences of their peers – which can be *positive or negative*. Positive peer pressure is when teens follow their friends to do well, such as studying hard in school. Negative peer pressure is when teens are more likely to engage in negative behaviours like drug use or shoplifting in order to fit in with a group.

Different factors cause teens to react to peer pressure in different ways. Gender, age and whether they feel rejected by their peers or family are some factors. For example, boys give in more easily to peer pressure than girls, particularly in dangerous situations. Younger teens are more easily influenced than older teens, with peer pressure at its highest when they are 14-16 years old. Individual characteristics such as confidence level, personality and degree of maturity also make a difference.

Your group wants to give a class presentation about peer pressure that teenagers experience in Hong Kong. Discuss with your group what to include in your presentation. You may want to talk about:

- the kinds of peer pressure that Hong Kong teenagers have
- the positive and negative influences of peer pressure
- what teens can do when they face peer pressure
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you face pressure at school?
2. What pressures do parents place on their children?
3. Do you think it is important to follow what your friends do?
4. Have you experienced peer pressure in school?
5. Can peer pressure help us in our studies?
6. Do you think boys and girls react differently to peer pressure?
7. Is it possible to have no peer pressure at all?
8. Has peer pressure been a positive influence in your life?